

— SPM 381 — CONSUMER BEHAVIOR IN SPORT

Sports and Social Media I

SPM381 Consumer Behavior in Sport

Arcadia University Sport Management · Week 2-1

What is social media to you?

How did social media change your life?

The False Self on Social Media

- *What's on your mind?*
- *Social Media Friendship — Real vs. Virtual??*
- Watch video clip (linked below).

Source — [youtube.com/watch?v=QxVZYiJKl1Y](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QxVZYiJKl1Y)

Social Media Quick Facts

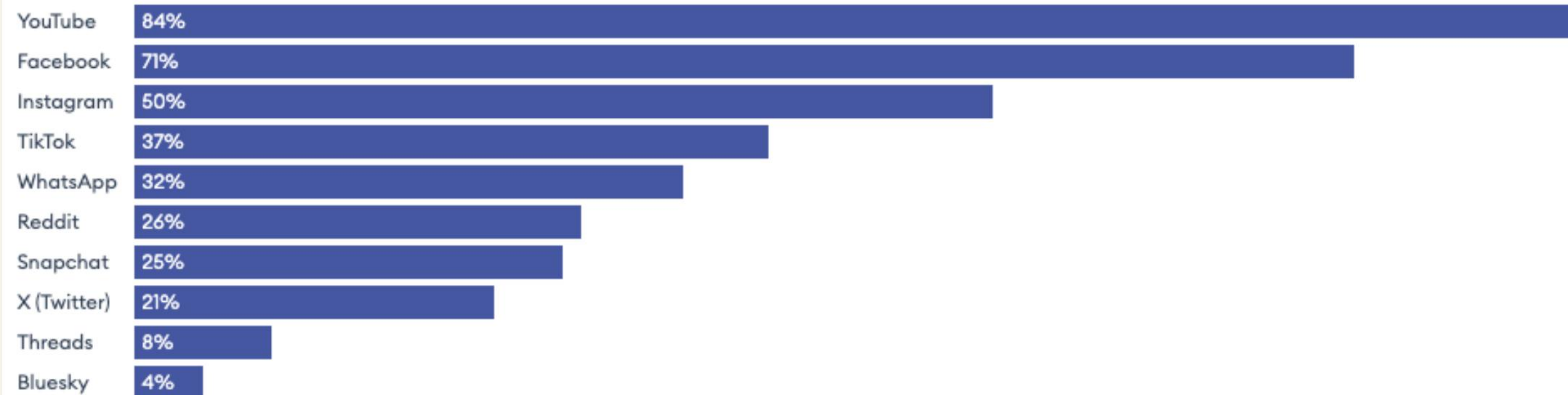
- 5.79 billion people now use social media worldwide, more than two-thirds of everyone on Earth
- Meta's daily active people across Facebook, Instagram, Messenger and WhatsApp hit 3.56 billion in Q1 2026
- Meta's advertising-driven revenue hit \$56.31 billion in Q1 2026, up 33% year-over-year
- Brand awareness is now the #1 goal for 59% of social media marketers, more than double the 29% who ranked it first in 2025
- Social media in 2026 is less about driving immediate sales than influencing the decisions that happen afterward. People increasingly discover brands, products and creators on social platforms before researching, comparing and purchasing elsewhere



Social Media Quick Facts cont.

- More than 8 million advertisers now use at least one of Meta's AI ad creative tools, with especially strong adoption among small and medium-sized businesses
- Reddit's daily active user base grew 17% year-over-year to 126.8 million in Q1 2026
- 84% of shoppers say they feel more confident in their purchase decisions after researching on Reddit
- LinkedIn may have lower overall marketer adoption than Instagram or Facebook, but it remains the most-used B2B platform

Top Social Media Platforms in 2026



Source: Pew Research Center "Americans' Social Media Use 2025"

Forbes ADVISOR

Perception of Social Media

- Trendy — passing fad
- → Marketing platform
- → Now an integral part of life

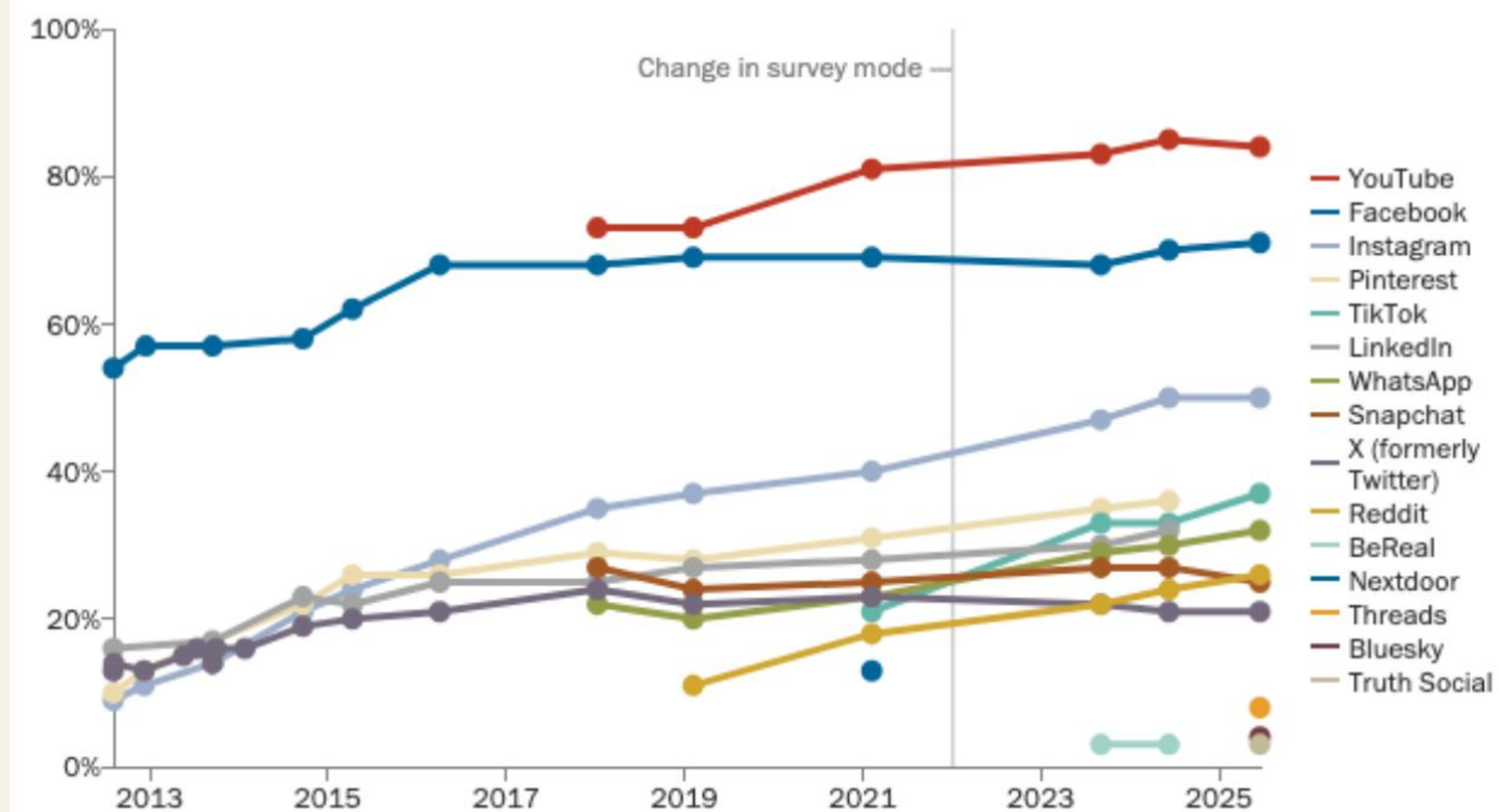
Source — forbes.com/sites/moneywisewomen/2012/08/08/the-developing-role-of-social-media-in-the-modern-business-world/



Source – mediabistro.com/alltwitter/social-media-then-now_b59744

Which social media platforms are most popular

% of U.S. adults who say they ever use ...



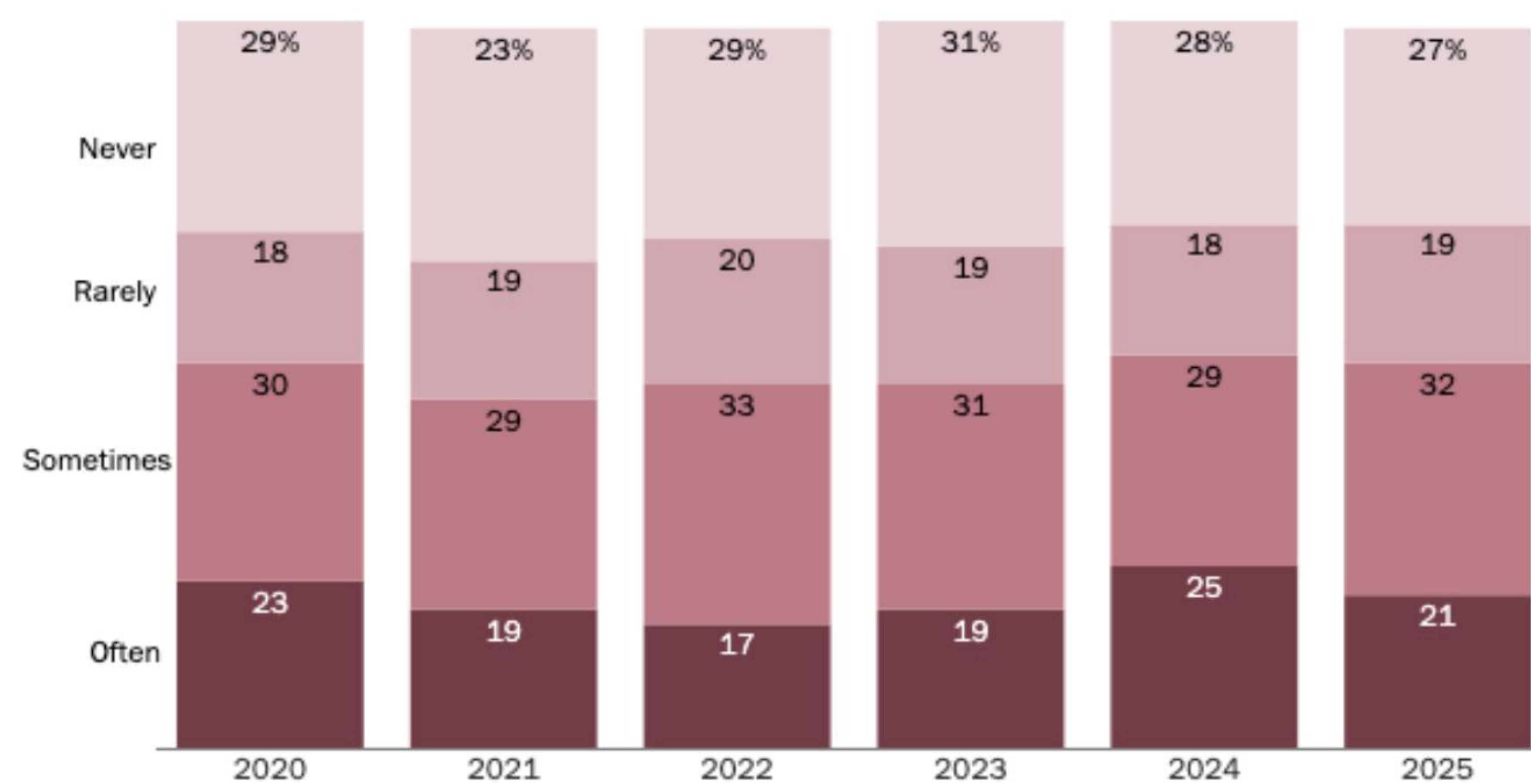
Source – pewresearch.org/internet/fact-sheet/social-media/

Who uses each social media platform?

AGE	RACE &		HOUSEHOLD		
	GENDER	ETHNICITY	INCOME	EDUCATION	COMMUNITY
	Ages 18-29		30-49	50-64	65+
YouTube	95		92	85	64
Facebook	68		80	74	57
Instagram	80		62	40	19
TikTok	63		44	30	12
WhatsApp	37		40	30	20
Reddit	48		35	16	6
Snapchat	58		31	13	4
X (formerly Twitter)	33		25	16	10
Threads	15		10	6	3
Bluesky	6		5	3	2
Truth Social	1		3	5	4

News consumption on social media

% of U.S. adults who say they get news from social media ...



Source – pewresearch.org/journalism/fact-sheet/social-media-and-news-fact-sheet/

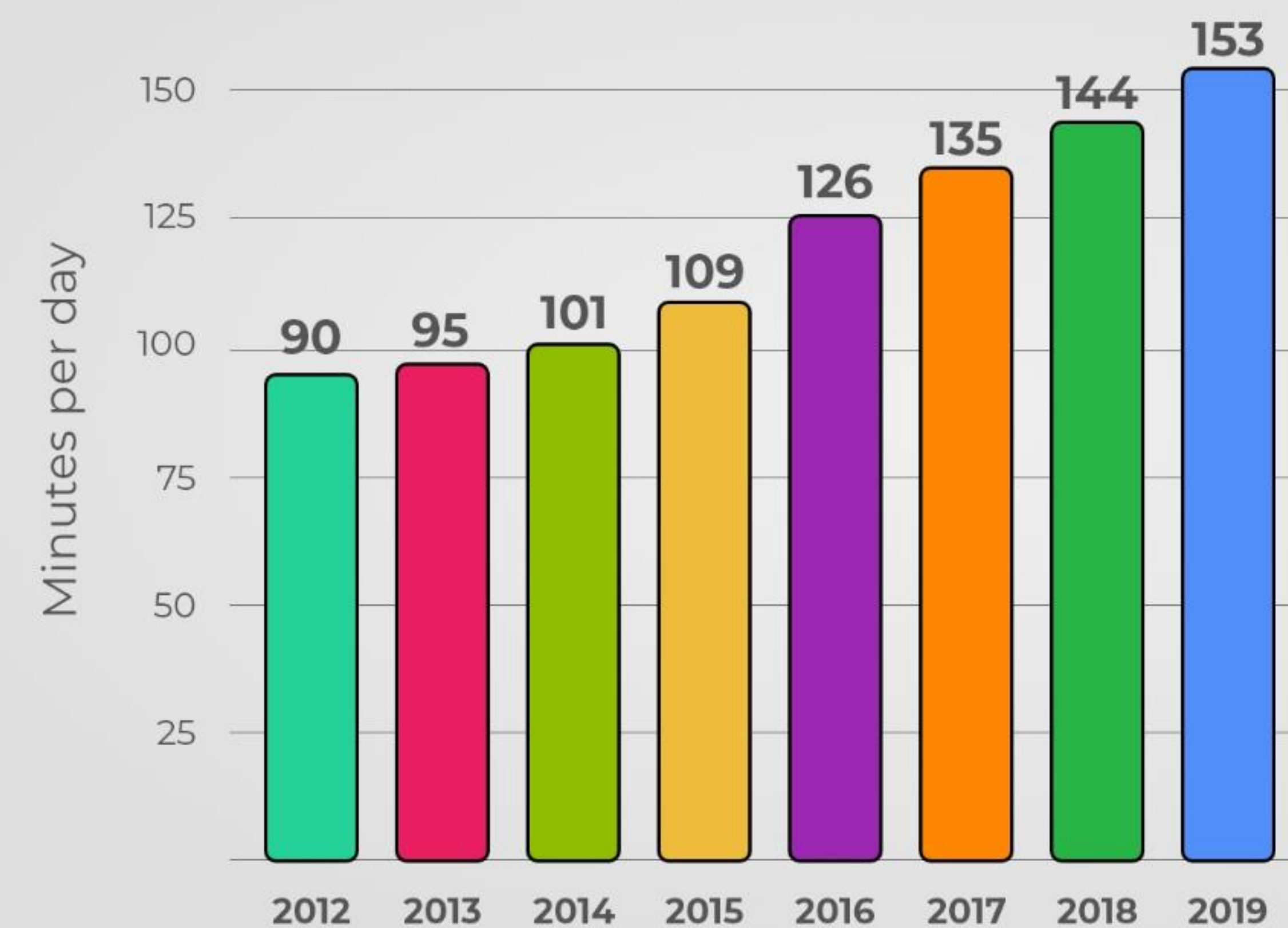
Demographics and party identification of regular social media news consumers in the U.S.

% of U.S. adults who say they *regularly* get news from each social media site



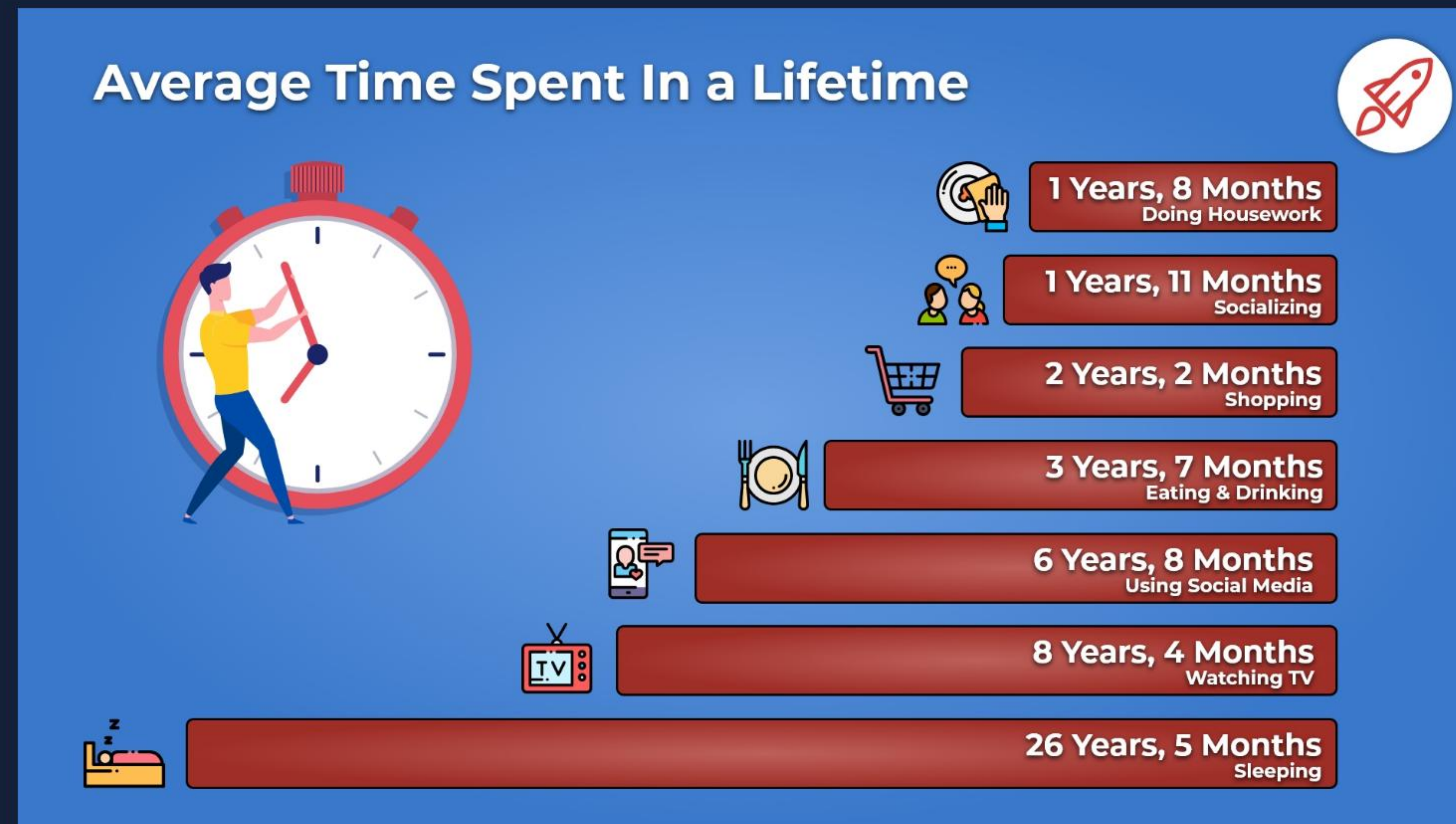
The Growing Impact of Social Media

Daily Time Spent On Social Networking
2012-2019 (in minutes)



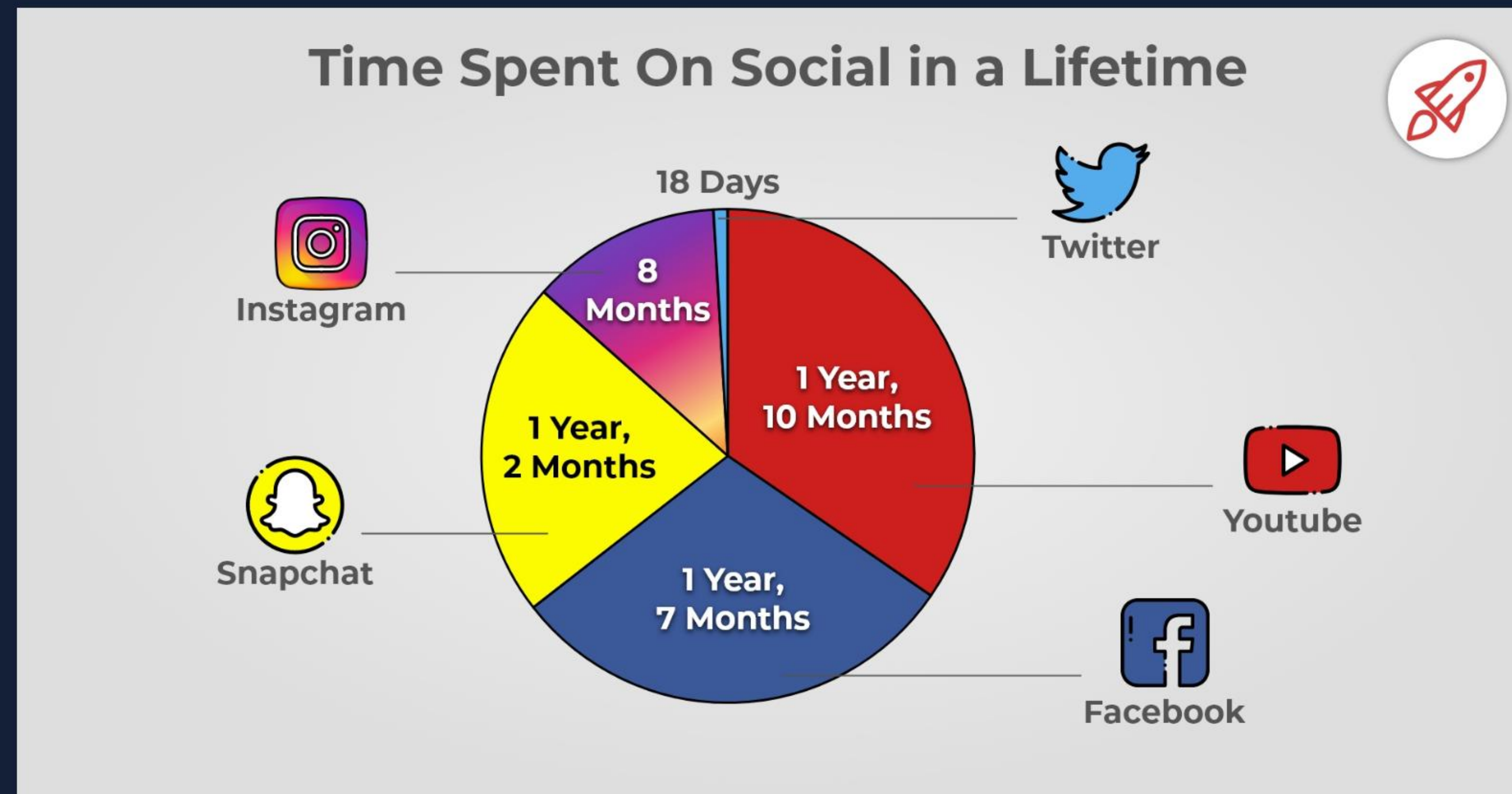
Source – broadbandsearch.net/blog/average-daily-time-on-social-media

The Growing Impact of Social Media cont.



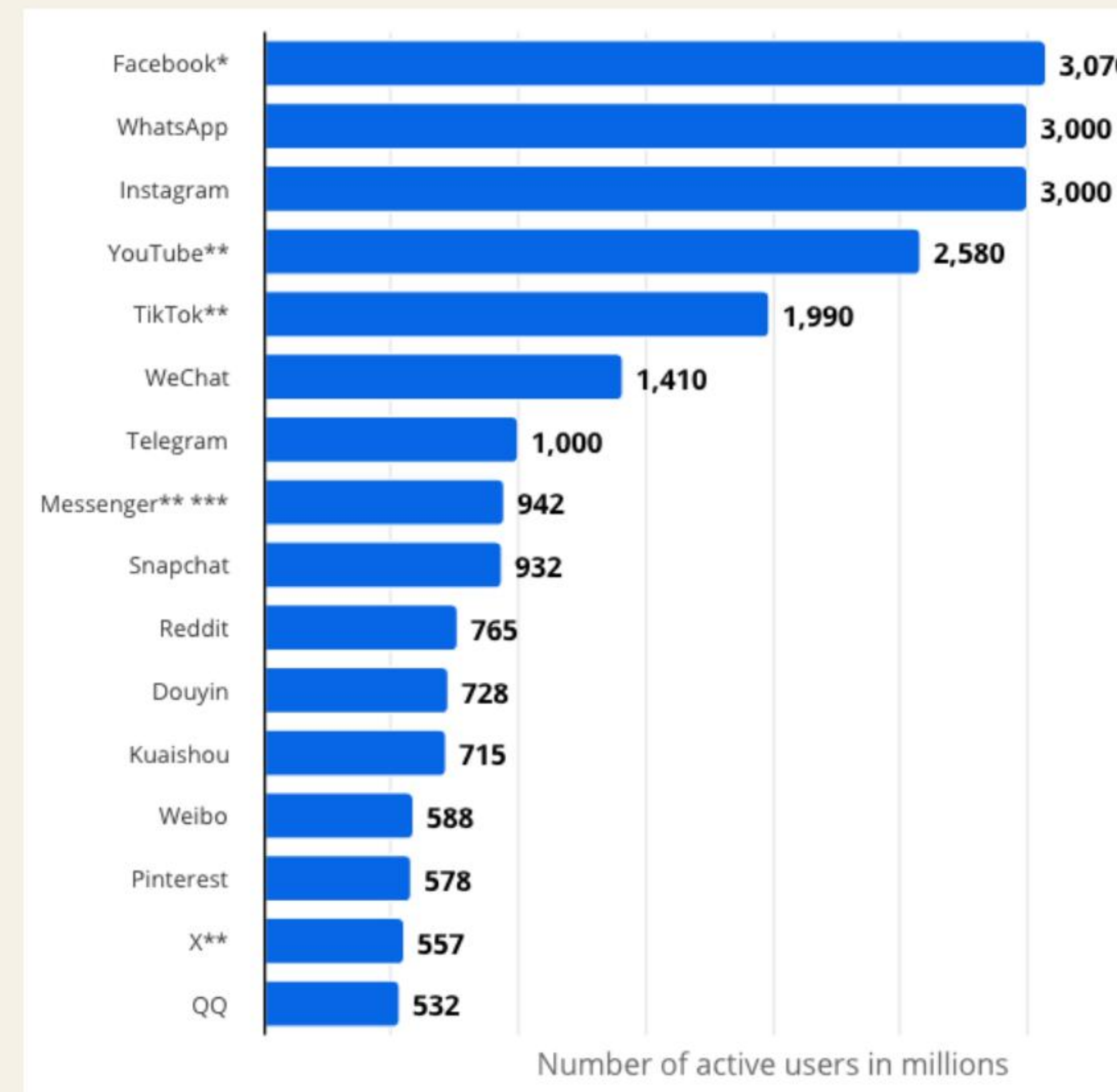
Source – broadbandsearch.net/blog/average-daily-time-on-social-media

The Growing Impact of Social Media cont.

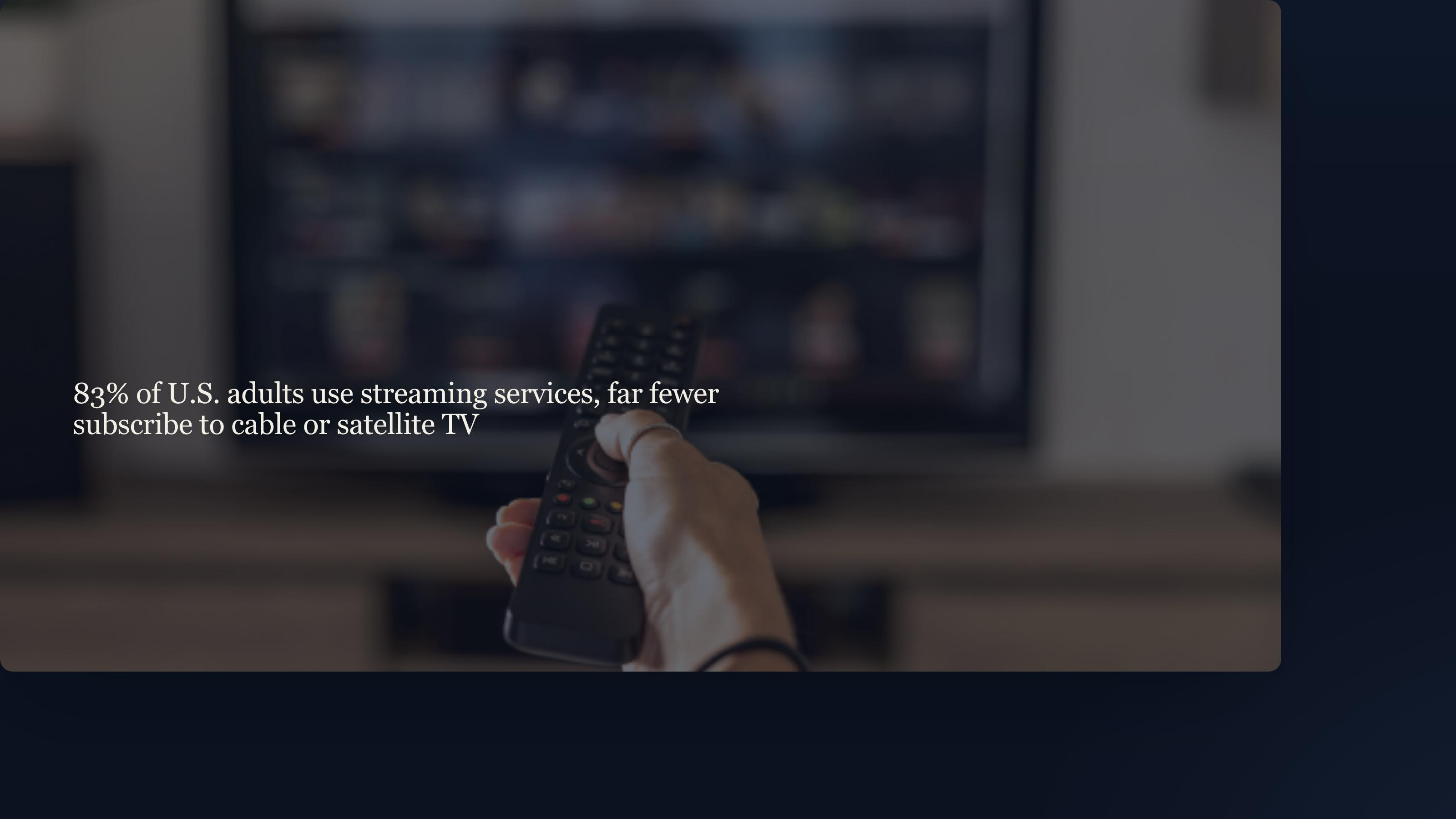


Source – broadbandsearch.net/blog/average-daily-time-on-social-media

Most popular social networks worldwide as of Oct 2025, ranked by number of active users

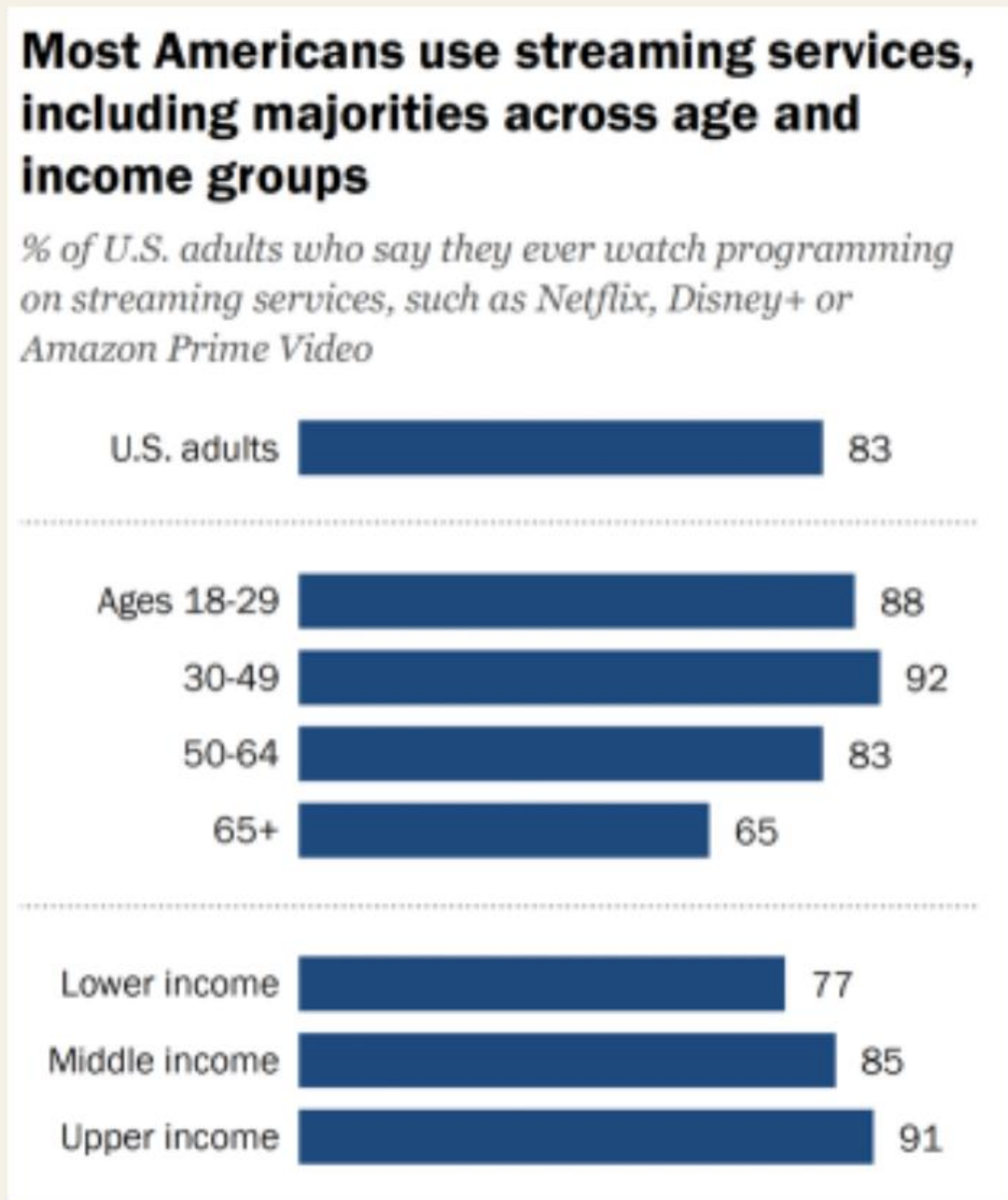


Source – [statista.com/statistics/272014/global-social-networks-ranked-by-number-of-users/](https://www.statista.com/statistics/272014/global-social-networks-ranked-by-number-of-users/)

A hand holding a black remote control, pointing it towards a television. The television screen displays a grid of various video thumbnails, suggesting a streaming service interface. The background is slightly blurred, focusing attention on the hand and the TV.

83% of U.S. adults use streaming services, far fewer
subscribe to cable or satellite TV

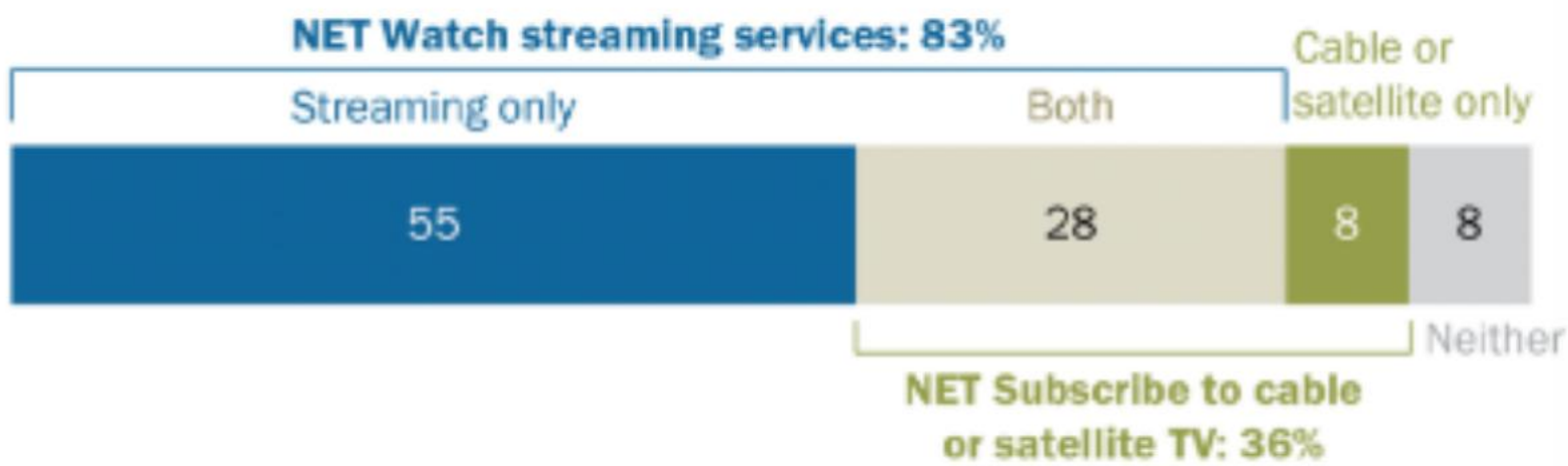
Most Americans use streaming services, including majorities across age and income groups



Source – [pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/](https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/)

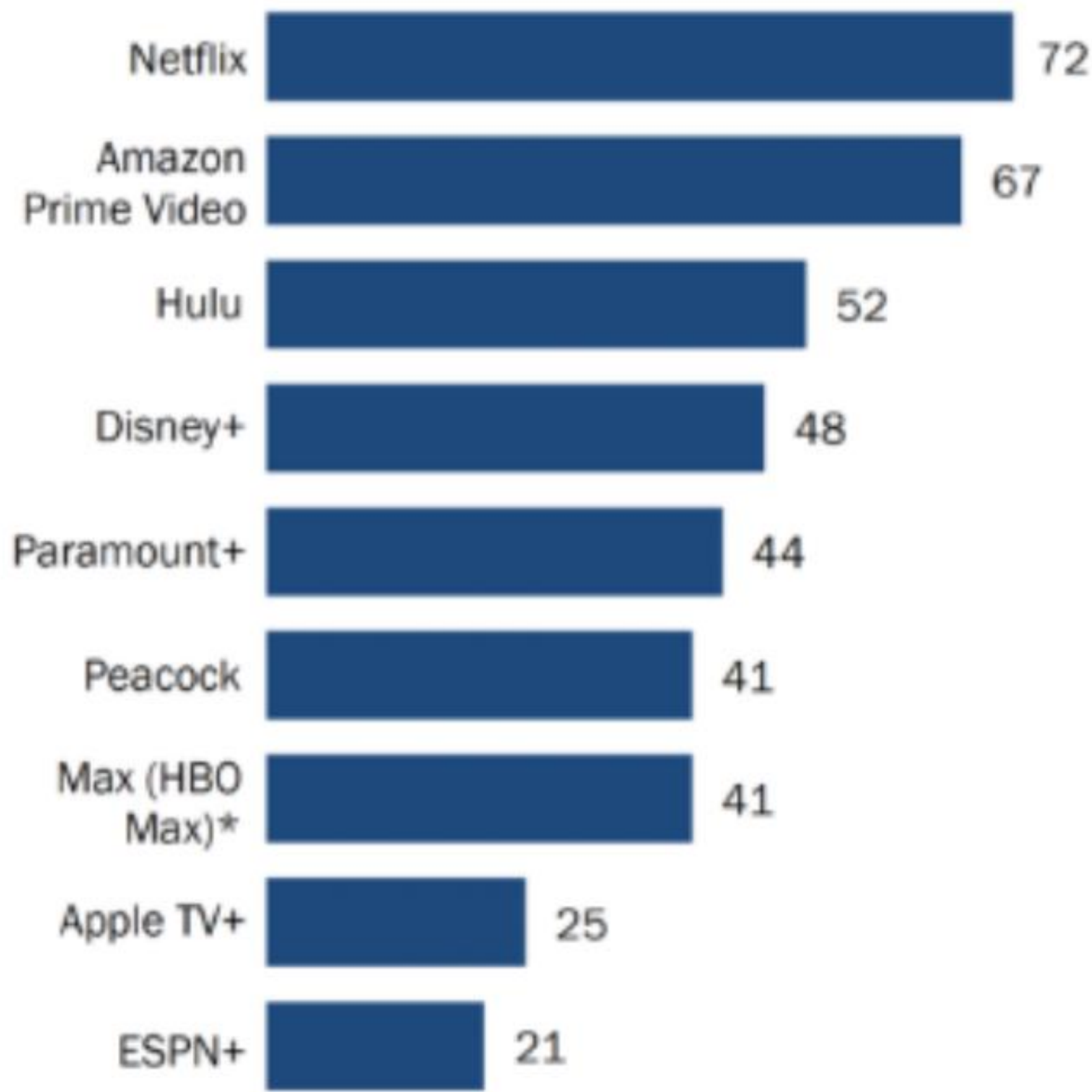
Just over half of Americans watch streaming services but do not subscribe to cable or satellite TV

% of U.S. adults who say they ...



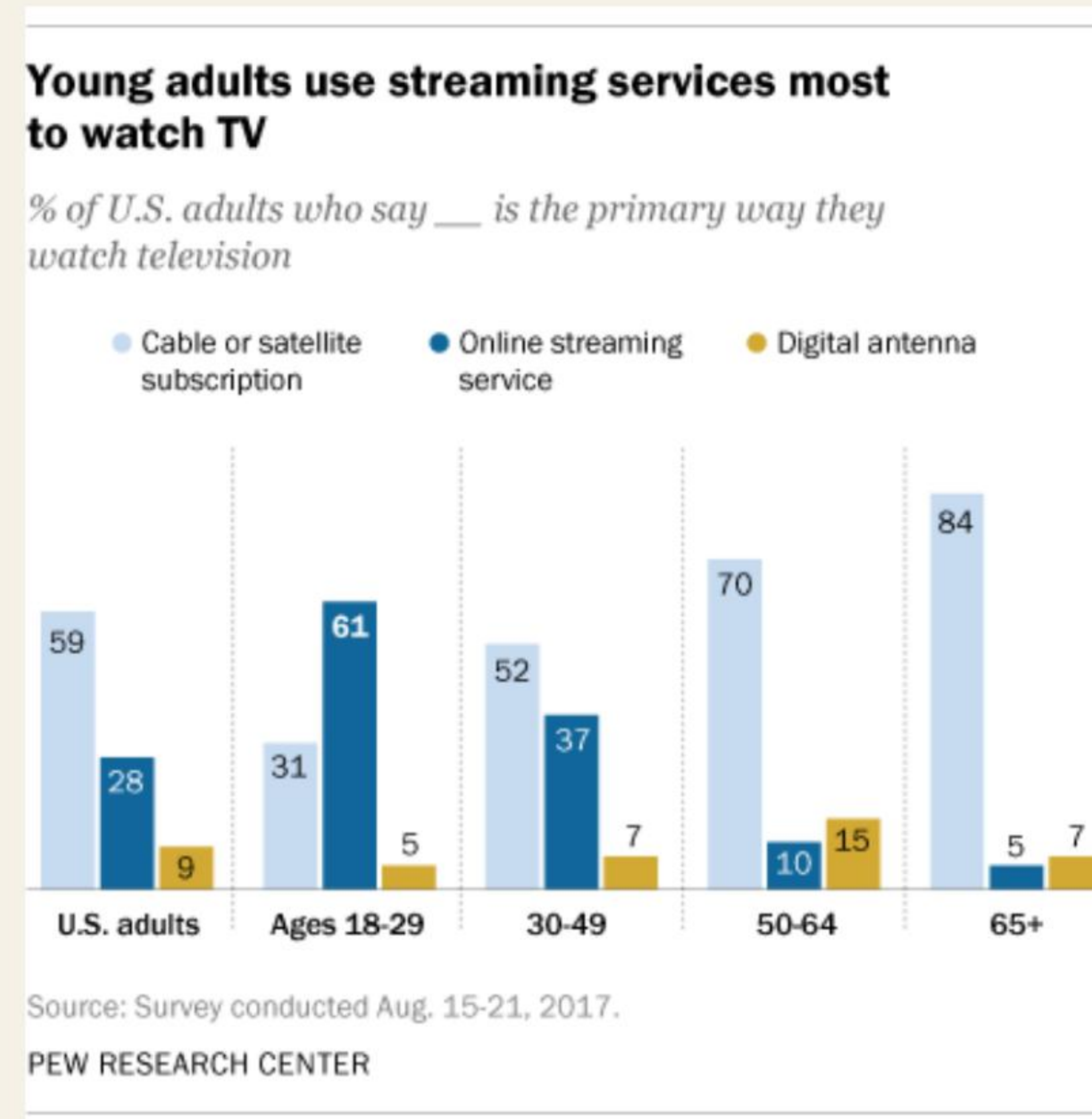
Majorities of Americans watch Netflix, Amazon Prime Video

% of U.S. adults who say they ever watch programming on ...



Source – [pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/](https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/)

About 6 in 10 young adults in U.S. primarily use online streaming to watch TV



Source – [pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/](https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/)

How Sports Fans Engage with Social Media?

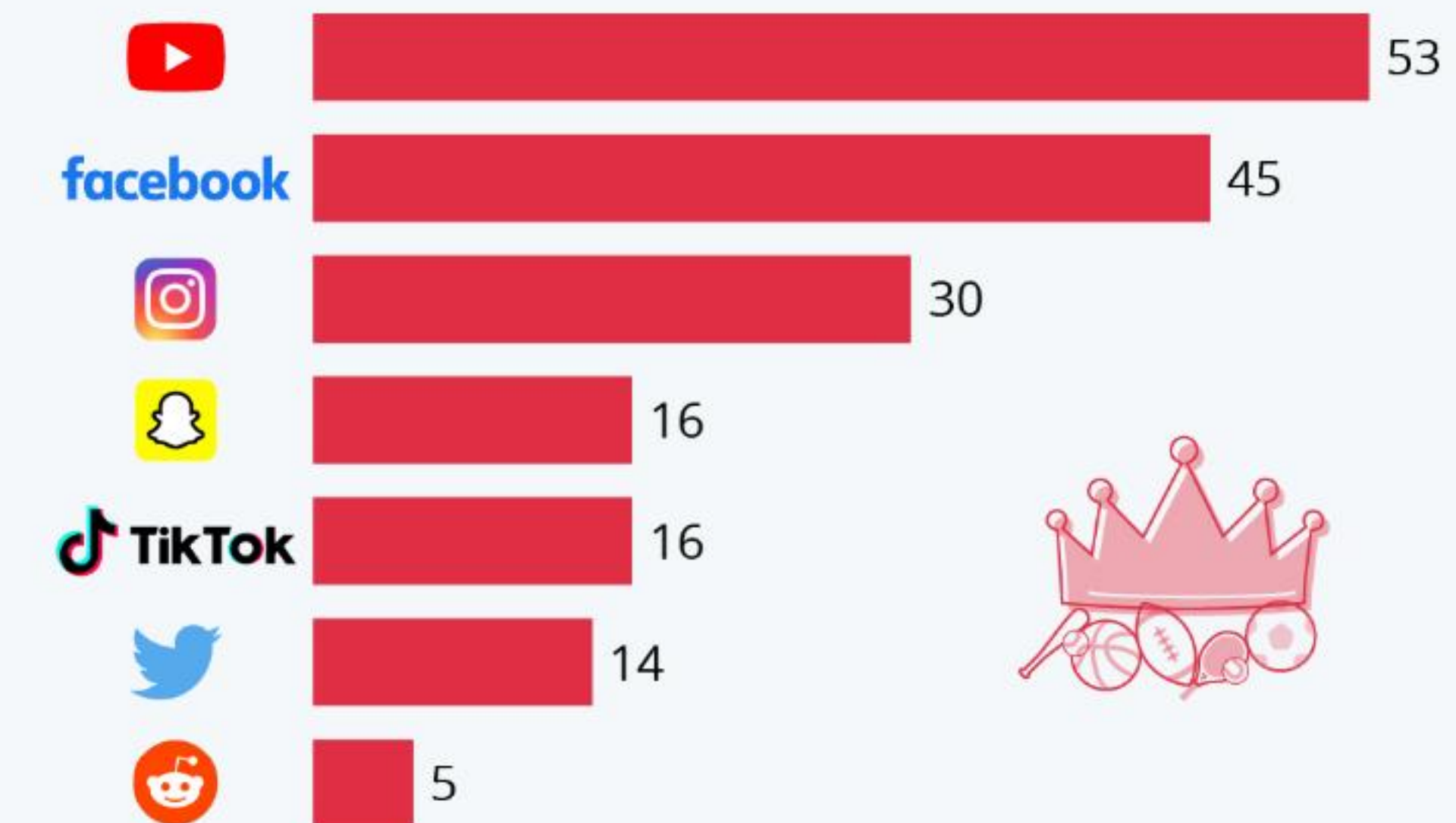


How Sports Fans Engage with Social Media cont.



YouTube is King of Sports Highlights

Percentage of Americans who view sports highlights on each of the following social media platforms

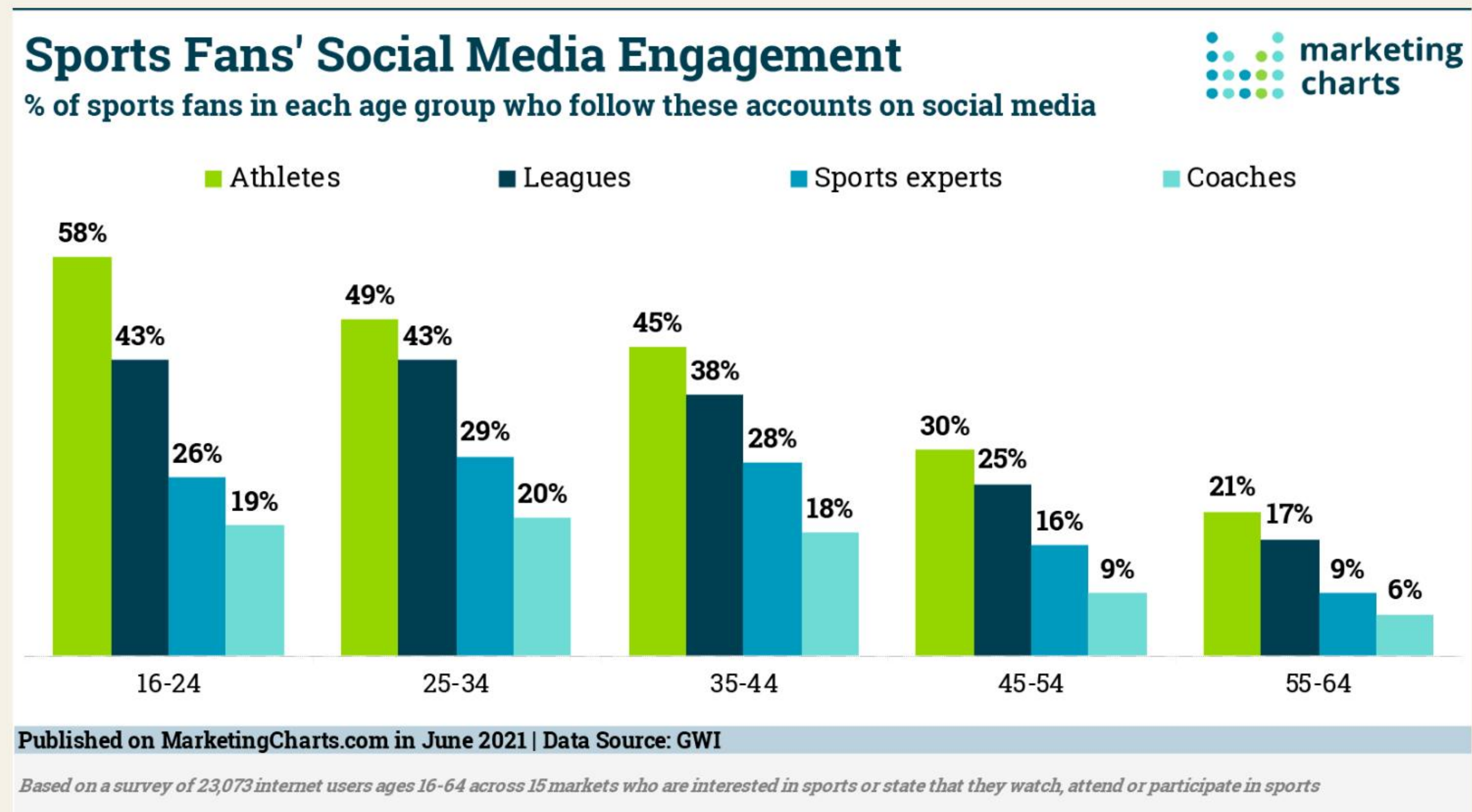


Survey conducted Sept. 2020 of 1,400 U.S. adults
Sources: Ring Digital, Survata



statista

How Sports Fans Engage with Social Media cont.

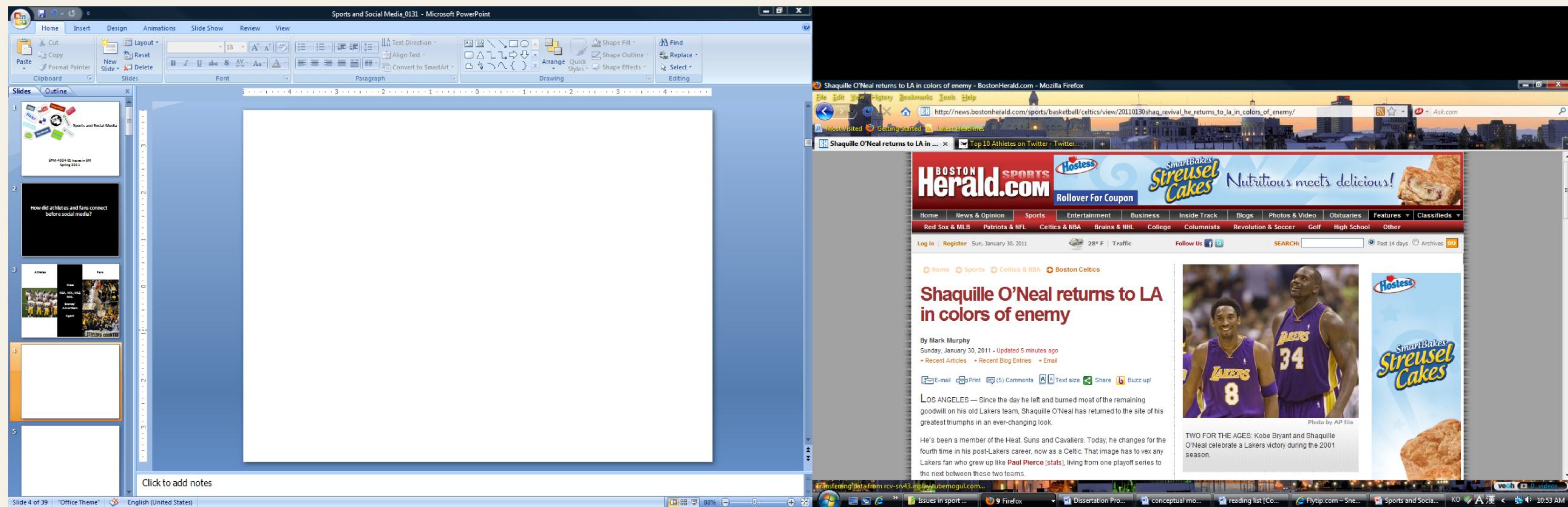


How did athletes and fans connect before social media?

- Athletes
- Press
- NBA, NFL, MLB, NHL
- Brands / Advertisers
- Agent
- Fans



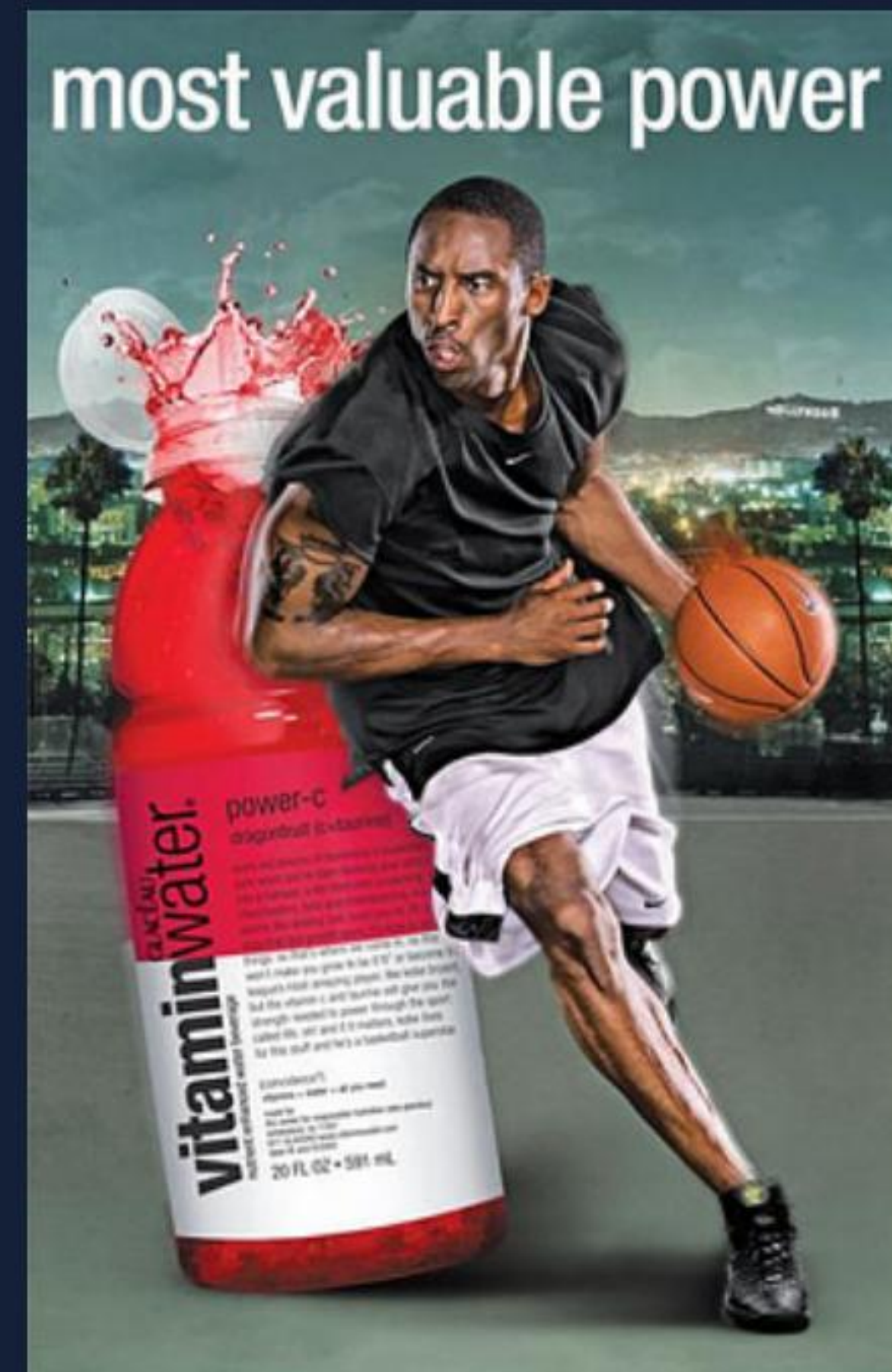
- Old days..







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20 FL OZ • 591 mL

- ✓ 3 championships... and counting
- ✓ 1,845 bottles of vitaminwater... and chugging
- ✓ 1 mvp award... and long overdue

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I'm chasing perfection. Elevating my game.
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Natural fit and motion. Supernatural performance.

NIKEBASKETBALL.COM

*The connection was controlled, filtered, and temporal
(Richard Ting)*

How do athletes and fans connect now using social media?

- Athletes
- Press
- NBA, NFL, MLB, NHL
- Brands / Advertisers
- Agent
- Fans
- Social Media
- "Social media is not replacing traditional media, but rather balancing it!" (Richard Ting)



- The new relationship model is a dialogue
- Not a monologue



Source – Paul Marobella – [slideshare.net/marobella/social-media-in-sports-the-athlete-1151579](https://www.slideshare.net/marobella/social-media-in-sports-the-athlete-1151579)

A Review of Recent History

- Web 1.0 to Web 2.0 in simple terms
- Web 1.0: Mostly a one-way read/write, centralized experience (1997-2007)
- A brand, person, company etc. builds a website, populates with content.
- People visit that website to read the content but have limited ways to interact, dialogue and generate unique content to share with the site owner and other visitors.
- Some interaction occurs through forums, message boards and email.
- In web 1.0, users would typically browse via a singular device, the PC.

Source – Paul Marobella – slideshare.net/marobella/social-media-in-sports-the-athlete-1151579

What changed?

- Web 1.0 to Web 2.0 in simple terms



A Review of Recent History cont.

- Web 1.0 to Web 2.0 in simple terms
- Web 2.0: The participatory, conversational, social & decentralized web (2007-present)
- The new web empowers people to interact, generate, and share multi-media content across the web, seamlessly.
- The web has moved from a solo activity to a series of participatory activities enabled by new web applications, platforms, technologies and methodologies.
- Website have become 2-way platforms and facilitators of people, content and conversations.
- In addition, these content platforms are accessible from multiple devices- the PC, mobile phones, netbooks, and gaming consoles.

Source – Paul Marobella – slideshare.net/marobella/social-media-in-sports-the-athlete-1151579

A Review of Recent History cont.

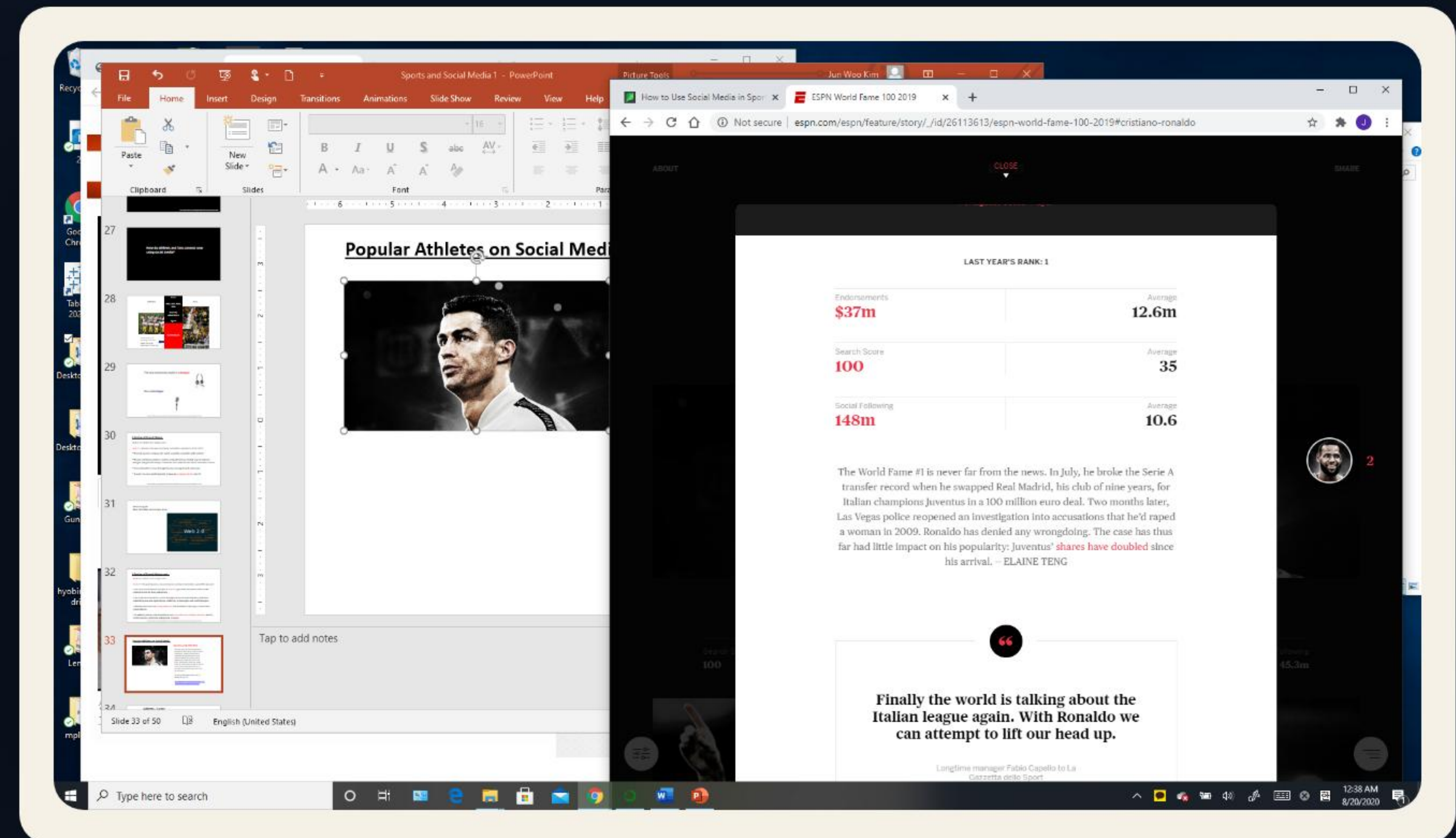
- Web 3.0: Decentralized, open to everyone, and built on top of blockchain technologies
- The main distinctions between Web 2.0 and Web 3.0 involve data storage, connectivity, currency, and decentralization.
- Web 2.0 is about creating content and interacting with websites.
- Web 3.0 means immersing yourself in the digital experience, and it involves concepts like individual control of personal data, cryptocurrency, and decentralized record keeping on the blockchain.
- Web 3.0 relies on cryptocurrencies and a decentralized finance (DeFi) model. This is part of the decentralization objective, which shifts control from centralized companies or governments to users or the collective.
- The premise of decentralization extends beyond currency, covering everything from apps to data.



Source: Enlear Academy 2018

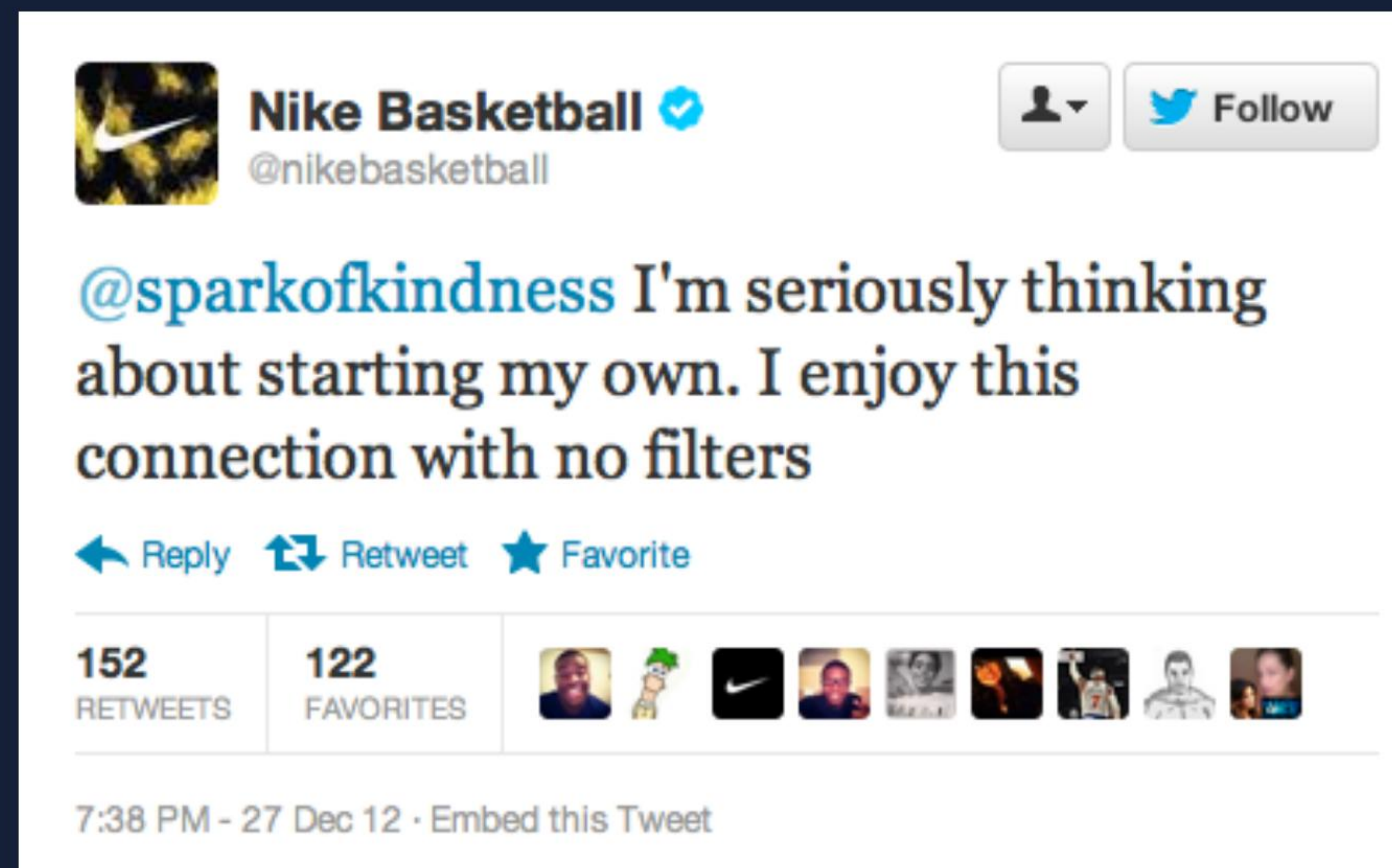
Popular Athletes on Social Media

- World Fame 100 (ESPN, 2019)
- How do you know you're famous? When everyone is talking about you, or in this day and age, looking you up on Google. For our fourth annual World Fame 100, we bring you each athlete's most searched moment worldwide, as measured by Google Trends. To identify the 100 most famous athletes in the world, we started with 800 of the biggest names in sports, drawn from 78 countries. We then ranked them based on a formula that took into account three fame factors:
- Search score
- Endorsement dollars
- Social media followers



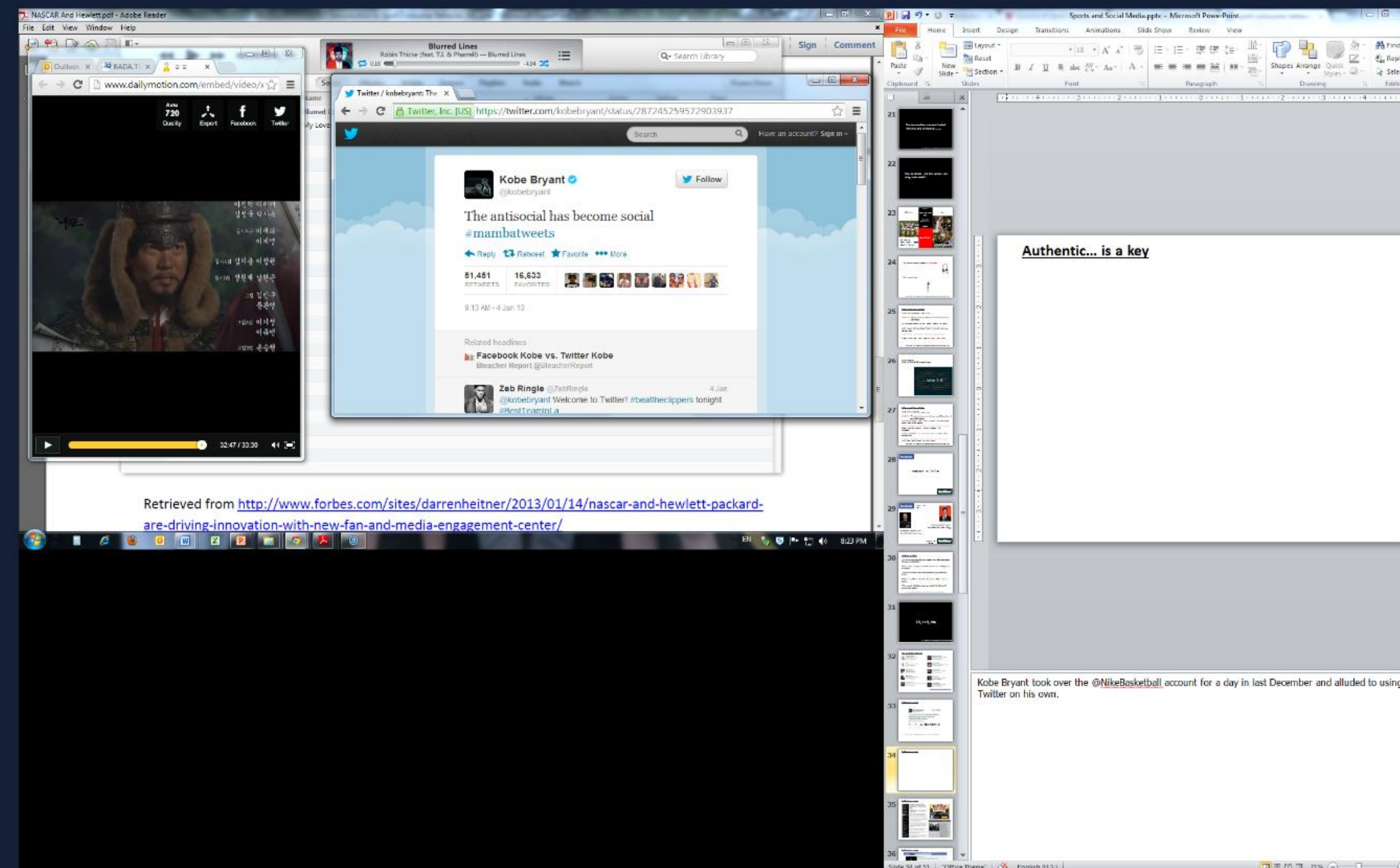
Authentic... is a key

- Kobe Bryant took over the @NikeBasketball account for a day in December 2012 and alluded to using Twitter on his own.



Source – twitter.com/kobebryant/status/287245259572903937

Authentic... is a key cont.



Source – twitter.com/kobebryant/status/287245259572903937

Authentic... is a key cont.

Sports and Social Media_0131 - Microsoft PowerPoint

Home Insert Design Animations Slide Show Review View Format

Clipboard Font Paragraph Drawing Editing

Slides Outline

18 Annotations

19 Top 10 Twitter Accounts

20 Top 10 News Papers in the U.S.

21

22

Click to add notes

Top 10 News Papers in the U.S.

	Newspaper	City	State	Daily Circulation
1	The Wall Street Journal	New York	New York	2,061,142
2	USA Today	McLean	Virginia	1,830,594
3	The New York Times	New York	New York	876,638
4	Los Angeles Times	Los Angeles	California	600,449
5	The Washington Post	Washington	District of Columbia	545,345
6	Daily News	New York	New York	512,520
7	New York Post	New York	New York	501,501
8	San Jose Mercury News/ Contra Costa Times/ The Oakland Tribune	San Jose	California	477,592
9	Chicago Tribune	Chicago	Illinois	441,508
10	Houston Chronicle	Houston	Texas	343,952

Shaq turns into statue at Harvard Sq. » Sports » EagleTribune.com, North Andover, MA - Mozilla Firefox

http://www.eagletribune.com/sports/d416244588/Shaq-turns-into-statue-at-Harvard-Sq

Most Visited Getting Started Latest Headlines

Shaq turns into statue at Harvard Sq.

CAMBRIDGE (AP) — It started with a simple tweet.

Boston Celtics big man Shaquille O'Neal sent a tweet to followers yesterday afternoon that he was headed to Harvard Square to pose silently for photographs.

He had promised the stunt two weeks ago on Boston sports radio station 98.5 FM without specifying a time.

For more than an hour, the 38-year-old NBA veteran posed as a statue while dozens of curious onlookers took pictures of him just off the campus of Harvard University.

Shaq said nothing, but witnesses say he did smile at some fans' comments.

Afterward, Shaq tweeted a "thank you" to those who showed up.

O'Neal and the Celtics open the season Tuesday in Boston against LeBron James and the Miami Heat.

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Related Photos

Boston Celtics center Shaquille O'Neal, center, poses as a statue in Harvard Square in Cambridge, Mass., Thursday, Oct. 21, 2010. O'Neal sent a Twitter tweet to followers, then arrived and posed in silence for more than an hour just off the campus of Harvard University. (AP Photo/The Boston Globe, Yoon S. Byun) ** MANDATORY CREDIT. NO INTERNET USE. MAGS OUT. BOSTON OUT. QUINCY OUT. TV OUT. NO SALES **

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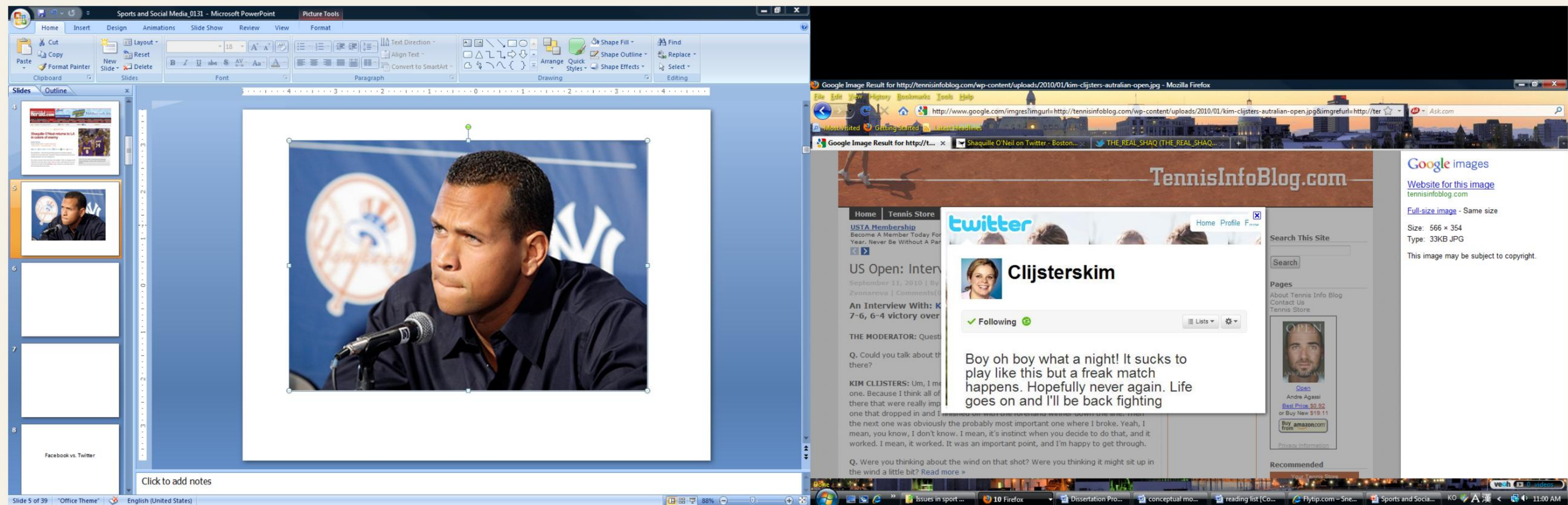
HAS YOUR BUILDING SHIFTED OR SETTLED? Contact Woodford Brothers Inc. for straightening. ...more »

MV PLASTERING &

Slide 20 of 34 "Office Theme" English (United States) 76% 10 Firefox 4 Microsof... Facebook in ... Sports and S... PowerPoint ... Facebook an... sports_social... KO 10:32 PM

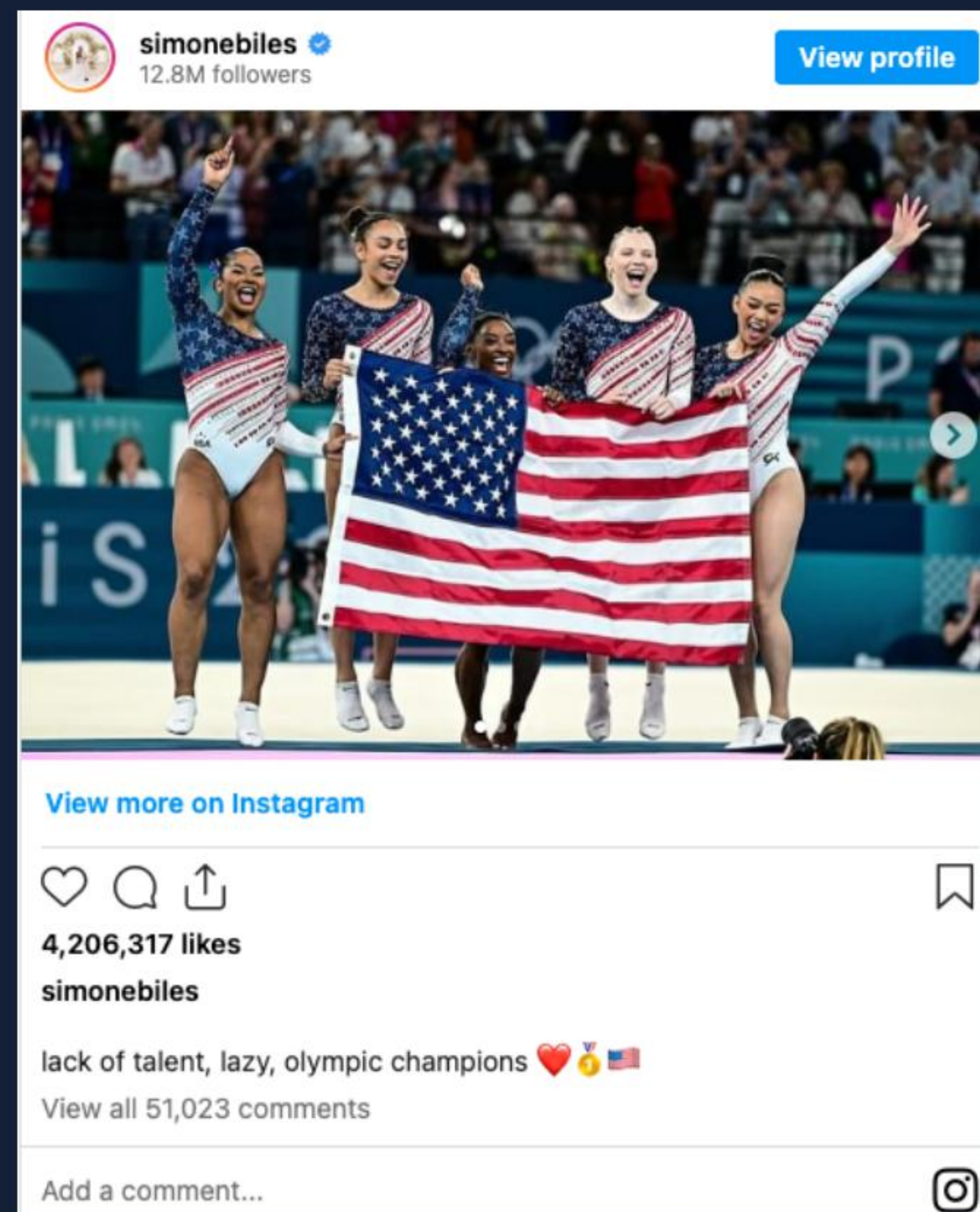
Transparency

- Kim Clijsters about her stunning loss 6-0, 6-1 against Nadia Petrova at 2010 Australian Open.

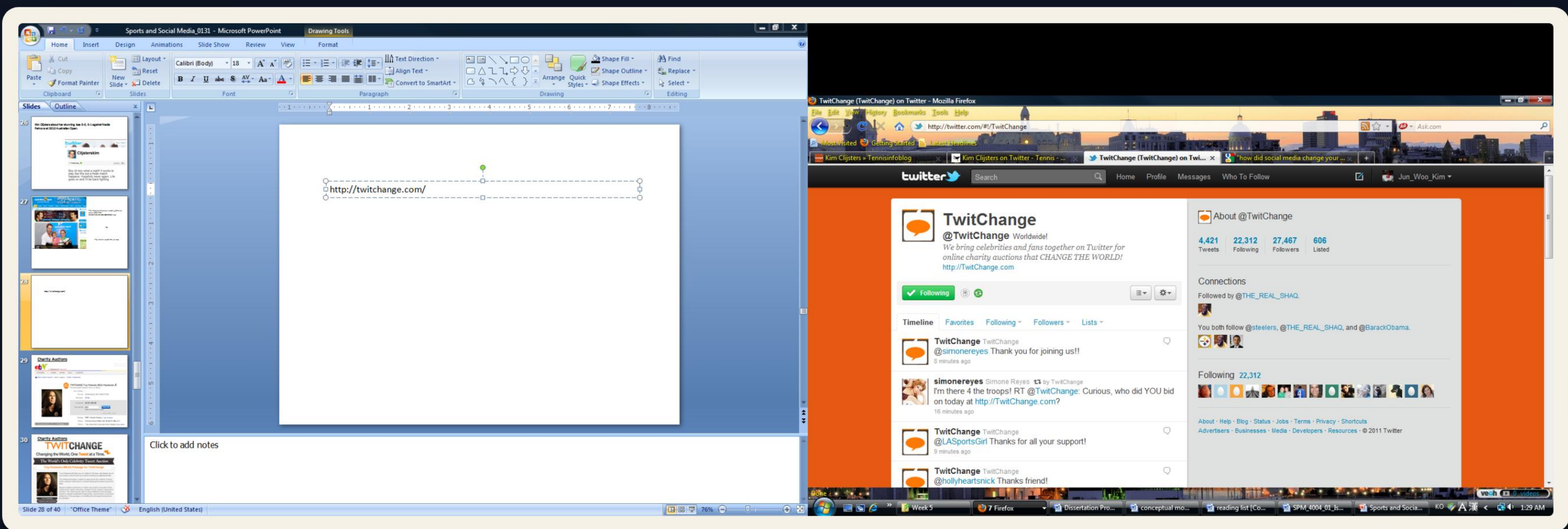


Transparency cont.

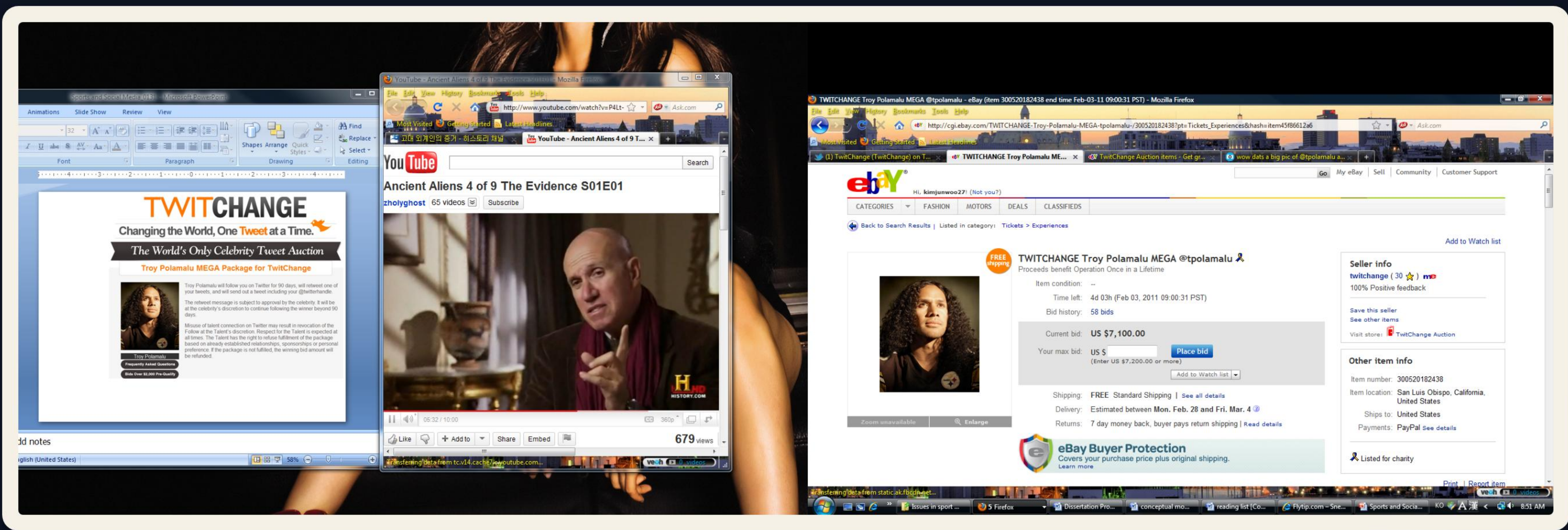
- The caption appears to be a not-so-thinly-veiled shot at 2020 Olympic teammate MyKayla Skinner. “Besides Simone, I feel like the talent and the depth just isn’t like what it used to be” and “the girls just don’t have the work ethic.”



Charity Auctions



Charity Auctions cont.



Athletes for Purpose

- At the beginning of 2023, Instagram partnered with three of the UK's most exciting athletes. The goal? To shine a light on the causes that mattered the most to them. Together with Jack Grealish, Emma Raducanu and George Russell we co-produced Reels content throughout the year, giving them a platform to amplify the causes that they hold close to their hearts and share their own personal experiences. Their chosen advocacies? For Jack it was child disability, for George it was exploring the topic of mental health awareness and for Emma it was the importance of young children staying active in sports



Source – creators.instagram.com/blog/athletes-for-purpose

Fulfillment of Fans' Curiosity

- Steven Jackson
- 2004-2012
- 2013-2014
- 2015



Steven Jackson

- He decided to commission a documentary to give the fans a clearer sense of what players go through.
- “With the media and the Internet, we don’t have to allow for other media outlets to outline who we are as a person as an athlete”
- Video: sj39.com/film-video/

The image displays a dual-screen setup. On the left, a Microsoft PowerPoint window titled 'Sports and Social Media_0131 - Microsoft PowerPoint' is open. The active slide, titled 'Steven Jackson, Auteur', contains the following text:

He decided to commission a documentary to give the fans a clearer sense of what players go through.

“With the media and the Internet, we don’t have to allow for other media outlets to outline who we are as a person as an athlete”

<http://online.wsj.com/video/the-hardest-working-running-back/ED16AF7B-FC1B-43BF-B294-B7AE800010D8.html>

On the right, a Mozilla Firefox browser window is open to the website 'A Week in the Life With Steven Jackson | www.sj39.com | Official Web Site of Steven Jackson'. The website features a header with navigation links, a main content area with the title 'A WEEK IN THE LIFE WITH STEVEN JACKSON' and a description of the three-part web series, and a footer with social media links for Twitter and Facebook, and the 'SJ39' logo.

Source — online.wsj.com/video/the-hardest-working-running-back/ED16AF7B-FC1B-43BF-B294-B7AE800010D8.html

Justin Thomas

- PGA TOUR Originals: JT Unlocked presented by WHOOP offers unique insight from 14-time PGA TOUR champion Justin Thomas about his preparation to become his best possible self on and off the golf course, along with access to his life at home as he relaxes and unwinds from the various demands of life on TOUR.
- Watch video clip (linked below).



Source – youtube.com/watch?v=s6J2yWxW9sM&t=1078s

SOCIAL MEDIA IS ...	AND NOT...
TRANSPARANT	VEILED
INCLUSIVE	EXCLUSIVE
AUTHENTIC	CONTRIVED
VIBRANT	MONOTONE
PEOPLE-DRIVEN	BRAND-DRIVEN

Social media attack dooms Cutler

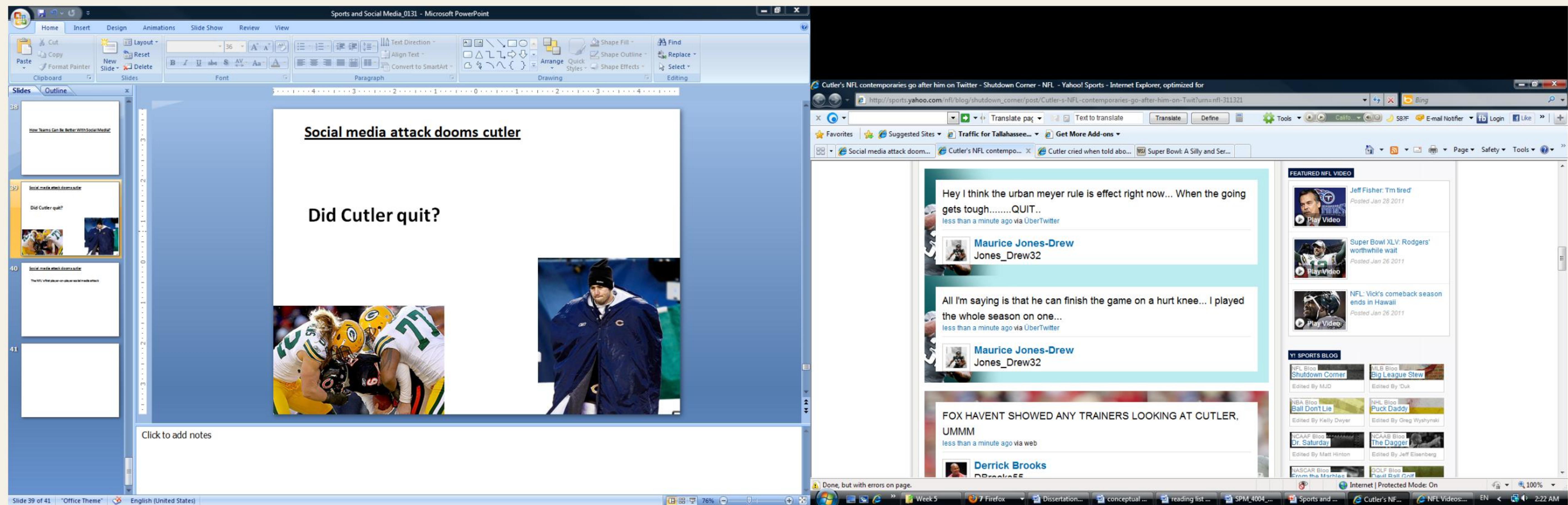
- Did Cutler quit? (2011 NFC championship)
- Watch video clip (linked below).



Source – [youtube.com/watch?v=J2_NHfEuDZw](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J2_NHfEuDZw)

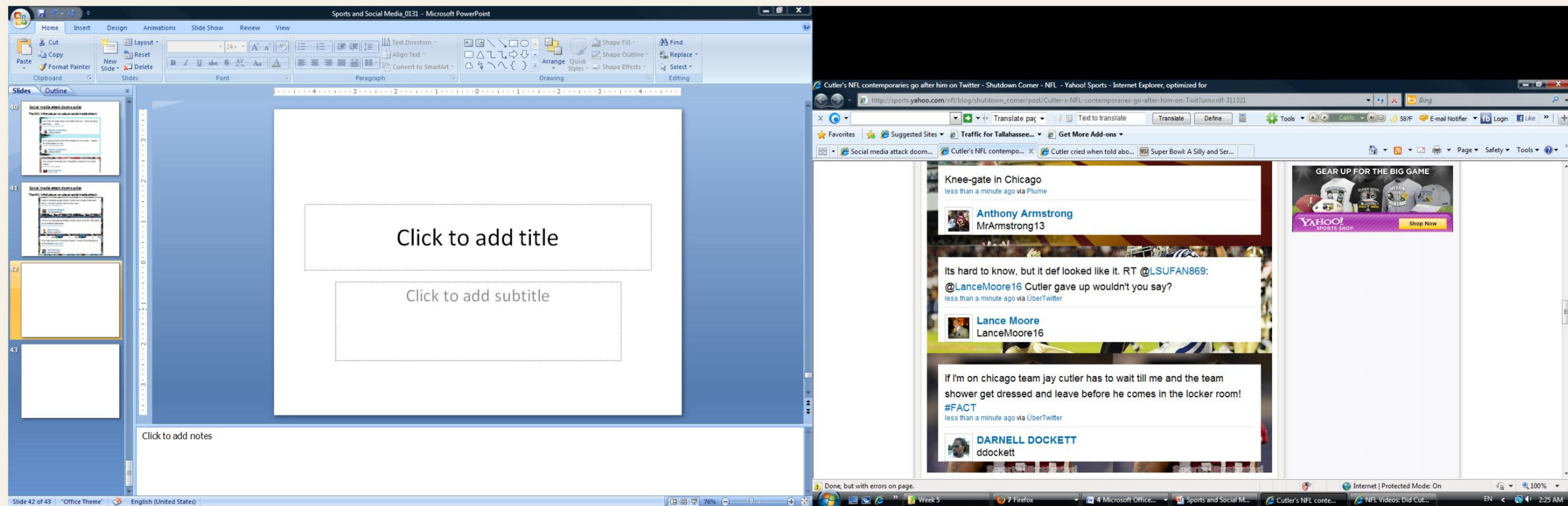
Social media attack dooms Cutler cont.

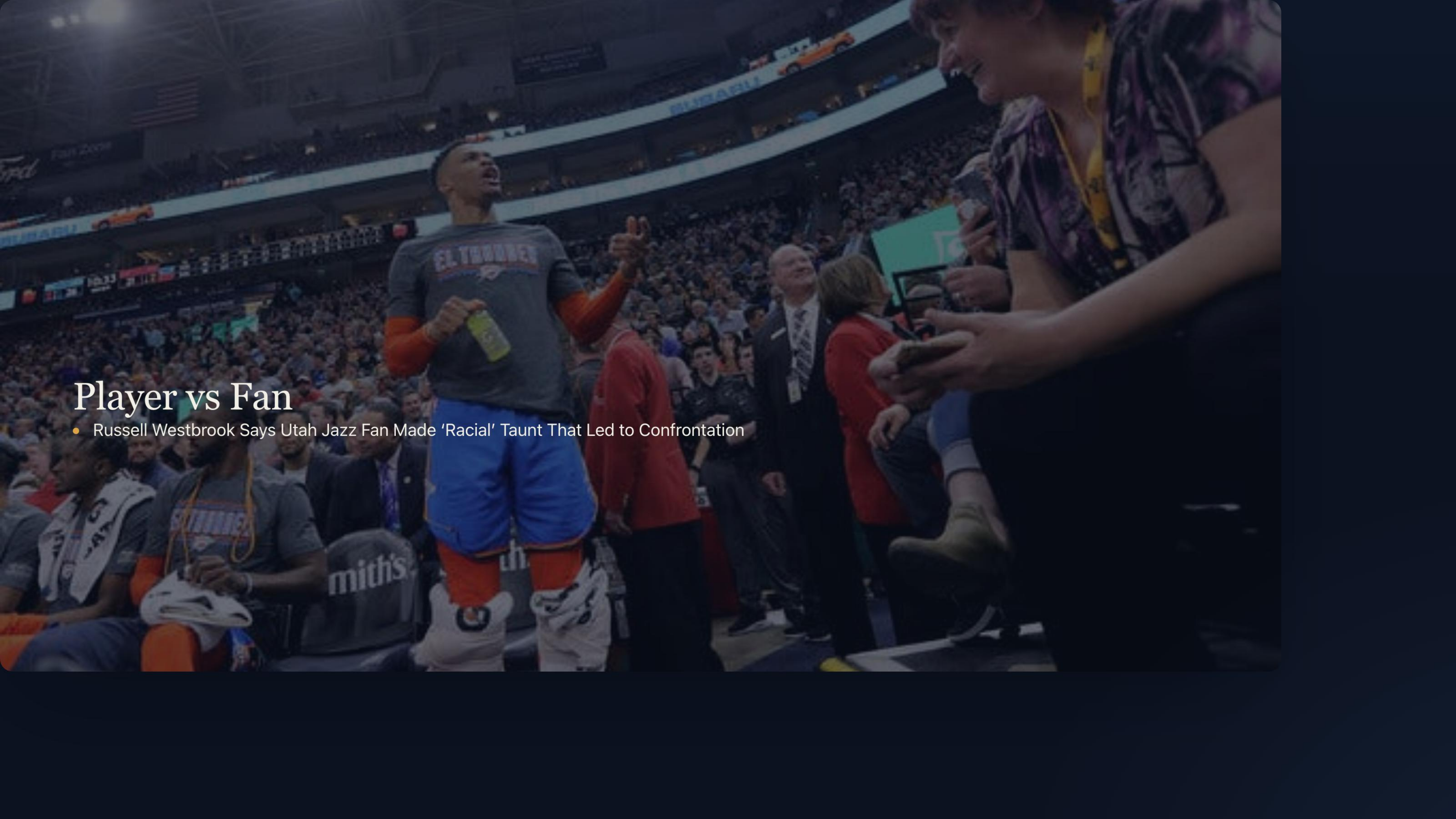
- The NFL's first player-on-player social media attack



Social media attack dooms Cutler cont.

- The NFL's first player-on-player social media attack



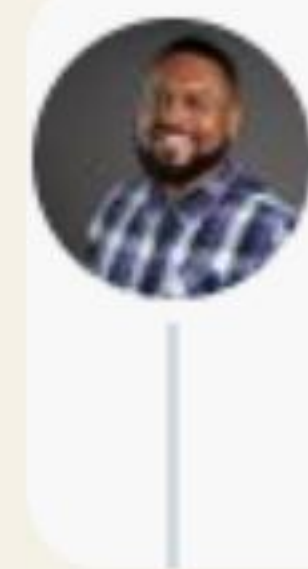
A photograph of Russell Westbrook on the Oklahoma City Thunder bench during a game. He is wearing a grey "EL THUNDER" t-shirt and blue shorts, holding a yellow water bottle and gesturing with his right hand. In the foreground, a fan's arm and hand holding a smartphone are visible, reaching towards Westbrook. The background shows a large arena filled with spectators and various advertisements like "Ford", "Budweiser", and "Mitsubishi".

Player vs Fan

- Russell Westbrook Says Utah Jazz Fan Made 'Racial' Taunt That Led to Confrontation

Player vs Fan cont.

- The confrontation between Westbrook and the Jazz fan.
- Watch video: youtube.com/watch?v=FCmjUyZBmcw



Eric Woodyard  @E_Woodyard · Mar 11, 2019

Things get heated between Russell Westbrook and Utah Jazz fans again. "I'll f*ck you up. You and your wife," he says. Not sure what these fans said to him, but he also had issues with Jazz fans during the postseason.



Eric Woodyard  @E_Woodyard

Replying to @E_Woodyard

Russell Westbrook says the fan and his wife told him to "to get down on your knees like you're used to" which is why he responded. "As for beating up his wife, I've never put my hand on a woman. I never will. Never been in any domestic violence before and never have," he said.



Player vs Fan cont.

- Jazz owner Gail Miller addresses crowd following Russell Westbrook incident.
- Watch video: youtube.com/watch?v=IWEUqog3F60
- The fan named Shane Keisel was permanently banned from Utah Jazz in 2019.
- The NBA announced that it had fined Westbrook \$25,000 "for directing profanity and threatening language to a fan."



Fans are able to ‘scrap and share’ exclusive content with their social networks contributing to the team, league and athlete’s ‘accumulated influence’ beyond traditional media platforms.

“Twitter is a waste of time”, says Manchester United manager Sir Alex Ferguson

